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First 90 Days | Forward Deployed Engineer, Frontier GenAI

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<https://russelldudek.github.io/deliotte/>

ENTRY PRINCIPLE

Earn technical trust first. Own a bounded workstream next. Prove client operability and reusable delivery value by day 90.

DAYS 1-30 - LEARN THE POD AND SHIP

Pair on client framing

Join senior FDEs in use-case discovery and working sessions.

EVIDENCE

Clear workflow and stakeholder map.

Learn the engineering system

Review approved platforms, reference architectures, security, evaluation, code, and documentation standards.

EVIDENCE

Pattern inventory and focused questions.

Build small implementations

Create tool-use and retrieval examples in the pod preferred platform.

EVIDENCE

Working implementation reviewed by a technical mentor.

Contribute to the real backlog

Add tests, documentation, runbook improvements, and issue resolution.

EVIDENCE

First merged engineering contribution.

OPERATING POSTURE

Listen for the difference between the nominal request and the actual work being changed. Make uncertainty visible. Ask where authority sits. Treat documentation and evaluation as part of the build, not cleanup after the demonstration.

<https://russelldudek.github.io/deliotte/>

DAYS 31-60 - OWN A BOUNDED WORKSTREAM

- Define one workflow baseline, value hypothesis, user, owner, and failure mode.
- Implement one bounded AI-enabled workflow with a realistic API or enterprise-system boundary.
- Define permissions, human approval, refusal, escalation, and rollback behavior.
- Instrument latency, cost, model behavior, tool outcomes, retries, and overrides.

60-DAY EVIDENCE

Representative users complete meaningful work; the decision path, authority model, tests, limitations, and observable behavior are documented.

DAYS 61-90 - PROVE OPERABILITY AND TRANSFER

- Support deployment-readiness and CI/CD decisions.
- Create runbook, monitoring plan, escalation logic, and ownership map.
- Pair with client engineers and operators until routine operation and diagnosis are independent.
- Convert repeated elements into reusable modules, evaluations, prompts, or reference patterns.

DAY-90 STANDARD

The workstream has a measurable baseline, explicit human-authority model, representative evaluation evidence, observable production behavior, named client owner, and a clear distinction between reusable pattern and client-specific implementation.